

Teaching Philosophy - Learning Theories Statement

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My teaching philosophy is guided by **Constructivism** and **Connectivism**, two learning theories that deeply reflect both my role as a Health Data Coordinator in oncology and my ongoing studies as a part-time MPH student in epidemiology. These theories resonate strongly because they emphasize how knowledge is actively built, shared, and applied, just as I experience in my daily work with complex health data and in preparing others to confront and solve real-world public health challenges.

Constructivism shapes my belief that learning occurs most effectively when individuals actively create meaning by connecting new ideas to their prior experiences. In oncology and public health, this is evident when interdisciplinary teams meet to review patient histories and diagnostic data during tumor boards, transforming complex information into actionable care decisions. I bring this philosophy into teaching by designing case-based activities where students analyze cancer incidence data and develop community-level interventions. This approach mirrors how practitioners link evidence with population health outcomes. **For instance, detailed case reports, meeting notes, and project summaries illustrate how collaborative interpretation not only deepens understanding but also strengthens decision-making skills.**

Connectivism adds an essential layer to my philosophy for today's highly interconnected digital environment, where knowledge is distributed across diverse networks, databases, and professional communities. In oncology and epidemiology, staying current means not just locating reliable information but also effectively filtering, integrating, and applying it. To support this, I create interactive dashboards that combine clinical, genomic, and epidemiological datasets to aid research and decision-making in cancer outcomes. **These digital resources, combined with curated online reference libraries and ongoing collaborative discussions, demonstrate how connected learning fosters continuous innovation and teamwork.**

Together, Constructivism and Connectivism shape my teaching approach, balancing rigorous technical knowledge with collaborative, networked learning experiences. My ultimate goal is to prepare people who can build meaningful understanding from shared experiences and confidently navigate complex digital resources to tackle challenging health issues with integrity, insight, and purpose.